



ARUNDATHI INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES

Survey No. 444, Dundigal (V), Gandimaisamma (M)
Medchal-Malkajgiri District, HMDA Hyderabad-500043

OFFICE ORDER: AIMS/ADMIN/2025-26

Date: 25th June 2026

OFFICE ORDER

Formation of POSH Internal Committee (IC)

In pursuance of UGC (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal of Sexual Harassment of Women Employees and Students in Higher Education Institutions) Regulations 2015 read with Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, the complaints relating to Sexual harassment at the work place.

The IC of the College comprises of the following members, constituted in accordance with the POSH Act, 2013 and UGC Regulations, 2015:

S.No.	Name and Designation	Role
1.	Dr. Suma Preeti Professor	Presiding Officer (Chairperson)
2.	Dr. Radha Professor	Member – Professor (Pre/Para Clinical Department)
3.	Dr. T. Vijay Kumar	Member – Professor (Clinical Department)
4.	Mrs. Ravuri Suez Director Marpu Trust	External Member (NGO / POSH Expert)
5.	Dr. Lalitha Devi Professor	Member – Women's Issues / Social Work / Counselling
6.	Mrs. Kaveri Professor	Member – Nursing Superintendent / Chief Nursing Officer
7.	Mr. Tagore Bala	Member – Women's Rights / Legal Experience
8.	Sudha Rani (Hr)	Member – Administrative Officer / HR Representative
9.	Subbalaxmi	Member – Lady Hostel Warden
10.	Dr. Mounika	Member – Counsellor / Psychologist (Optional)
11.	Dr. Asiya Ameera Senior Resident	Member – Female Resident Doctor Representative
12.	Ms. Janaki	Member – Female UG Student Representative

13.	Swathi Technician	Member – Female Non-Teaching Staff Representative
14.		

Process of making complaint of sexual harassment –

An aggrieved person is required to submit a written complaint to the IC within three months from the date of the incident and in case of a series of incidents within a period of three months from the date of the last incident. Other details provided in annexure-I

The complaint can be mailed to arundathihospital@gmail.com


DEAN 2.8.26-

Copy: All Notice boards/HoDs/Concerned Members/File.

Annexure-I

Internal Committee (IC)

Constitution of IC-SHW for considering complaints of sexual harassment of women employees at Arundathi Institute of Medical Sciences

In Compliance with the instructions of National Commission for women and guidelines issued for implementation of the directives of Hon'ble Supreme Court Judgment dated 13th August, 1997 in the case of Visakha and others vs. State of Rajasthan and Others on the subject of sexual harassment of women in the workplace, this institute had duly constituted a Complaint Committee for considering complaints of sexual harassment of women working in Arundathi Institute of Medical Sciences. The composition of complaints Committee was constituted on 22nd January, 2025 & now been revised and re-constituted on 25th June 2026 for considering complaints of sexual harassment of women employees. The details with regard to the Act & rules, role, functions etc. of IC are as given in the next sections.

The Members of the Internal Committee includes:

Presiding Officer:

The Presiding Officer is a woman who is responsible for conducting the inquiry into the complaint of sexual harassment. She must be a senior-level employee of the organization and should have experience in dealing with such issues.

Members:

These members should be representative of the diverse workforce of the organization. Also, they should have experience in dealing with issues related to sexual harassment.

And the employees are protected from sexual harassment in the workplace. The IC is responsible for

- a. Receiving complaints of sexual harassment.
- b. Conducting inquiries
- c. And making recommendations for resolution.

The IC also plays a key role in creating awareness about sexual harassment and promoting a culture of zero tolerance for such behavior within the organization.

It's important to note that the Internal Committee is not a judicial body and does not have the power to impose penalties. However, the committee may recommend disciplinary action against the accused and the organization must take appropriate action based on the finding of the enquiry.

Responsibilities of Internal complaints committee (IC) - The Internal complaints committee:

- a. provide assistance if an employee or a student chooses to file a complaint with the police;
- b. provide mechanisms of dispute redressal and dialogue to anticipate and address issues through just and fair conciliation without undermining complainant's rights, and minimize the need for purely punitive approaches that lead to further resentment, alienation or violence;
- b. protect the safety of the complainant by not divulging the person's identity, and provide the mandatory relief by way of sanctioned leave or relaxation of attendance requirement or transfer to another department or supervisor as required during the pendency of the complaint, or also provide for the transfer of the offender;
- d. ensure that victims or witnesses are not victimised or discriminated against while dealing with complaints of sexual harassment; and ensure prohibition of retaliation or adverse action against a covered individual because the employee or the student is engaged in protected activity.

The process for making complaint and conducting Inquiry -

The IC shall comply with the procedure prescribed in these Regulations and the Act, for making a complaint and inquiring into the complaint in a time bound manner. The institute shall provide all necessary facilities to the IC to conduct the inquiry expeditiously and with required privacy.

Process of making complaint of sexual harassment-

An aggrieved person is required to submit a written complaint to the IC within three months from the date of the incident and in case of a series of incidents within a period of three months from the date of the last incident' Provided that where such complaint cannot be made in writing, the presiding officer or any Member of the Internal committee shall render all reasonable assistance to the person for making the complaint in writing;

Provided further that the IC may, for the reasons to be accorded in the writing, extend the time limit not exceeding three months, if it is satisfied that the circumstances were such which prevented the person from filing a complaint within the said period." Friends, relatives, Colleagues, Co-students, Psychologist, or any other associate of the victim may file the complaint in situations where the aggrieved person is unable to make a complaint on account of physical or mental incapacity or death.

Process of conducting Inquiry-

- (1) The IC shall, upon receipt of the complaint, send one copy of the complaint to the respondent within a period of seven days of such receipt
- (2) Upon receipt of the copy of the complaint, the respondent shall file his or her reply to the complaint along with the list of documents, and names and addresses of witnesses within a period of ten days.

(3) The inquiry has to be completed within a period of ninety days from the receipt of the complaint. The inquiry report, with recommendations, if any, has to be submitted within ten days from the completion of the inquiry to the Executive Authority of the Institute. Copy of the findings or recommendations shall also be served on both parties to the complaint,

(4) The Executive Authority of the institution shall act on the recommendations of the committee within a period of thirty days from the receipt of the inquiry report, unless an appeal against the findings is filed within that time by either party.

(5) An appeal against the findings or /recommendations of the IC may be filed by either party before the Executive Authority of the institution within a period of thirty days from the date of the recommendations.

(6) If the Executive Authority of the institute decides not to act as per the recommendations of the IC, then it shall record written reasons for the same to be conveyed to IC and both the parties to the proceedings. If on the other hand it is decided to act as per the recommendations of the IC, then a show cause notice, answerable within ten days, shall be served on the party against whom action is decided to be taken, The Executive Authority of the institute shall proceed only after considering the reply or hearing the aggrieved person.

(7) The aggrieved party may seek conciliation in order to settle the matter. No monetary settlement should be made as a basis of conciliation. The institute shall facilitate a conciliation process through IC, as the case may be, once it is sought. The resolution of the conflict to the full satisfaction of the aggrieved party wherever possible, is preferred to purely punitive intervention.

(8) The identities of the aggrieved party or victim or the witness or the offender shall not be made public or kept in the public domain especially during the process of the inquiry.

(9). Interim redressal-

The institute may,

(a) transfer the complainant or the respondent to another section or department to minimise the risks involved in contact or interaction, if such a recommendation is made by the IC;

(b) grant leave to the aggrieved with full protection of status and benefits for a period up to three months.

(c) restrain the respondent from reporting on or evaluating the work or performance or tests or examinations of the complainant;

(d) ensure that offenders are warned to keep a distance from the aggrieved, and wherever necessary, if there is a definite threat, restrain their entry into the campus;

(e) take strict measures to provide a conducive environment of safety and protection to the complainant against retaliation and victimisation as a consequence of making a complaint of sexual harassment.

(10). Punishment and compensation-

- (1) Anyone found guilty of sexual harassment shall be punished in accordance with the service rules of the institute, if the offender is an employee.
- (2) Where the respondent is a student, depending upon the severity of the offence, the institute may,-
 - (a) withhold privileges of the student such as access to the library, auditoria, halls of residence, transportation, scholarships, allowances, and identity card;
 - (b) suspend or restrict entry into the campus for a specific period;
 - (c) expel and strike off name from the rolls of the institution, including denial of readmission, if the offence so warrants;
 - (d) award reformatory punishments like mandatory counselling and, or, performance of community services.
- (3) The aggrieved person is entitled to the payment of compensation. The institute shall issue direction for payment of the compensation recommended by the IC and accepted by the Executive Authority, which shall be recovered from the offender. The compensation payable shall be determined on the basis of-
 - (a) mental trauma, pain, suffering and distress caused to the aggrieved person;
 - (b) the loss of career opportunity due to the incident of sexual harassment;
 - (c) the medical expenses incurred by the victim for physical, psychiatric treatment;
 - (d) the income and status of the alleged perpetrator and victim; and
 - (e) the feasibility of such payment in lump sum or in instalments

(11). Action against frivolous complaint.-To ensure that the provisions for the protection of employees and students from sexual harassment do not get misused, provisions against false or malicious complaints have to be made and publicised. If the IC concludes that the allegations made were false, malicious or the complaint was made knowing it to be untrue, or forged or misleading information has been provided during the inquiry, the complainant shall be liable to be punished as per the provisions of sub regulations (1) of regulations 10, if the complainant happens to be an employee and as per sub-regulation (2) of that regulation, if the complainant happens to be a student. However, the mere inability to substantiate a complaint or provide adequate proof will not attract attention against the complainant. Malicious intent on the part of the complainant shall not be established without an inquiry, in accordance with the procedure prescribed, conducted before any action is recommended.

MEMBERS OF INTERNAL COMMITTEE (IC)

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